

COMPARISON • CANVAS • STRUCTURE

decision

The verdict slide — one chosen path, named explicitly.

Buy the platform; build the differentiation.

BUY AND CONFIGURE.

Adopt the vendor's data infrastructure — live in six weeks, freeing three engineer-quarters for the product layer where the differentiation actually lives.

BUILD IN-HOUSE.

Full control of schema and roadmap, but two to three engineer-quarters to reach parity with a platform we could adopt now and replace later.

Three reasons we are building.

BUILD

The platform is the product. Owning it owns the roadmap.

WHY NOT BUY

No vendor matches our compliance posture without surrender of control.

WHY NOT DELAY

Cost of waiting compounds: each quarter spent on workarounds is one fewer quarter on the platform.

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When NOT to reach for decision.

No clear chosen path.

If the cards don't resolve to a single verdict, the slide is back to being a comparison. Use

compare-prose

or

split-compare

; reserve decision for the resolved call.

Long body per card. Each card is one sentence of rationale. Paragraphs belong on the comparison slide upstream, not on the verdict slide.

Generic heading. The h2 carries the decision verb — Build, not buy. Adopt the framework. Pause the rollout. A heading like Next steps wastes the focal real estate.

RELATED COMPONENTS

See also.

- `compare-prose` — the comparison slide that should precede decision
- `split-compare` — comparison and verdict on one slide instead of two
- `closing` — the deck ends without a single-call verdict
- `big-number` — the decision is a quantitative commitment